

Nursing Foundations

Safety essentials: a focused review

01 Hand hygiene

Clean hands immediately before patient contact and after contact with the patient or their surroundings. Perform hand hygiene immediately after removing gloves. Gloves do not replace it. When hands are visibly soiled, use soap and water.

02 Medication awareness

Read the medicine label each time. Medicines can interact with other medicines, food and supplements. When instructions or possible interactions are unclear, ask a pharmacist or appropriate healthcare professional before use.

03 Check your understanding

Can you name two moments when hand hygiene is needed?
What should you do if a medicine label is unclear?
Review any missed assessment answers, then try the practice again.

Sources and further reading

CDC: Core Infection Prevention and Control Practices

FDA: Drug Interactions - What You Should Know

Educational demonstration only. Not a clinical protocol or validated assessment.
Follow your program, supervisor and institution policies in clinical practice.